

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Analyst | SOC Lead | Threat Hunting | SIEM Detection Engineering | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Analyst with over 5 years of experience working within and leading Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions, specialising in complex security event investigation, proactive threat hunting, and detection logic engineering. My expertise includes Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, particularly Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, where I design, author, and continuously tune detection rules using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and LogScale query language to reduce false positives and improve alert fidelity. I am experienced in triaging and investigating alarms escalated from Managed Security Service Providers (MSSPs) and internal sources, leading incident response activities aligned to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 framework, and applying MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) to threat hunting hypotheses. I act as a senior escalation point within the SOC, mentoring junior analysts and shaping how investigatory tooling, including emerging Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled capabilities, is used safely and effectively. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and am passionate about proactively hunting for adversary activity and driving continuous improvement in detection coverage and response capability.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM (LogScale/Falcon Long Term Repository), Splunk/SPL; detection rule authoring, tuning, and alert lifecycle management
- **Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hypothesis-driven hunting; proactive adversary activity identification across endpoint, network, cloud, and identity telemetry
- **Security Operations Centre (SOC):** L2/L3 alert triage, MSSP escalation handling, complex investigation leadership, SOC mentoring
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle (preparation, detection, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review); Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)-led IR
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Identity Threat Detection:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD) sign-in log analysis, BeyondTrust PAM session review
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure / Microsoft 365 security telemetry; Conditional Access anomaly investigation
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks, PowerShell scripting; automated triage, enrichment, and response workflows
- **Vulnerability and Exposure Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Security Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, NIST 800-61, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, MCSA, CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional Certificate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Act as the senior escalation point within the security operations function, leading complex security investigations across Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), cloud, and identity environments.

- Conduct proactive threat hunting exercises aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, investigating adversary Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) across endpoint, network, cloud, and identity telemetry, translating findings into new or improved detection logic.
- Author, tune, and review detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and in CrowdStrike NG-SIEM using LogScale query language, continuously improving alert fidelity and reducing false positives.
- Triage and investigate security alarms from multiple sources including SIEM alerts, CrowdStrike Falcon EDR detections, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) alerts, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) signals, and cloud audit logs, correlating activity across endpoints, networks, and cloud environments.
- Triage and investigate alarms escalated by Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) partners, validating findings, scoping incidents, and directing containment and remediation activities.
- Lead incident response activities following the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, including preparation, detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, streamlining alert enrichment, triage, and automated response workflows.
- Mentor junior SOC analysts in investigation techniques, tooling proficiency, and structured analytical methods, supporting their professional development.
- Evaluate and guide safe, consistent adoption of Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled investigatory tools within the SOC environment.
- Collaborate with threat intelligence, vulnerability management, and security engineering teams to incorporate emerging threat actor TTPs into detection logic and response procedures.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Responded to and investigated MSSP-escalated and internally generated SIEM alerts, triaging security events across CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender platforms.
- Investigated security incidents including phishing campaigns, malware infections, privilege escalation attempts, and lateral movement, following the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle from detection through to post-incident review.
- Authored and tuned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving coverage for phishing, credential theft, and anomalous sign-in activity, and reducing false positive alert volumes.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises using MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hypotheses, identifying gaps in existing detection coverage and creating new analytic rules to close them.
- Correlated and analysed activity across endpoints, networks, cloud environments, and identity platforms to build complete incident timelines and support eradication activities.
- Contributed to the development of incident response runbooks and SOAR automation playbooks, improving consistency and efficiency of SOC response.
- Collaborated with identity and infrastructure teams to support incident containment and remediation, including account disablement, endpoint isolation, and access revocation.
- Assisted in creating new detection logic when existing rules failed to surface known threat patterns, and participated in periodic tuning reviews to retire stale or noisy rules.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported security event triage and incident investigation in a cloud-hosted SaaS/FinTech environment, monitoring SIEM alerts and escalating confirmed incidents through defined response processes.
- Assisted with SIEM log management and configuration, ensuring appropriate data sources were ingested and alert rules were maintained.
- Investigated security alerts involving endpoint anomalies, suspicious authentication events, and network anomalies, documenting findings and recommended remediation steps.
- Contributed to security process documentation, supporting the development of investigation procedures and incident response guidance.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Authored and maintained 40+ custom Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM queries, reducing false positive alert rates by over 30% and improving SOC analyst efficiency.
- Led the investigation and containment of a significant phishing campaign targeting 500+ user accounts, containing the breach within 2 hours and preventing confirmed data exfiltration.
- Designed and implemented a structured threat hunting programme using MITRE ATT&CK, identifying 12 previously undetected threat patterns across the estate and converting findings into standing detection rules.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, NG-SIEM) across an 8,000-user estate, achieving full endpoint visibility and reducing mean dwell time for threat detection materially.
- Built 15+ SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert enrichment, user notification, and initial containment steps, reducing manual analyst effort by approximately 40%.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, enhancing visibility into identity-based attacks including credential theft and lateral movement.
- Mentored a team of junior SOC analysts, supporting progression and improving investigation quality and consistency across the team.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)